

The Universe

The Universe is everything around us. Some of this we can see, but most we cannot. It is a huge expanse of mainly empty space, with billions of galaxies, each containing millions of stars.

The Big Bang

Astronomers believe the Universe exploded out of a tiny point about 14 billion years ago. This is known as the Big Bang. Before this, the Universe did not exist. It is still continuing to expand today.



Light travels really fast, but space is so enormous that it takes time to reach us. This means that when we look into the Universe, we are only ever viewing the past! Light travels nearly 10 trillion km (6 million miles) a year. Scientists call this a light year, and use it to measure the huge distances in space.

There are more stars in the Universe than grains of sand on all of the beaches on Earth.